

JON A. EVANS

Chief AI Officer | Human-Centered Technologist | Strategic Futurist

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PROFILE

Technology executive with over 30 years of experience navigating disruptive innovation, from the dot-com boom through cloud infrastructure to the current AI transformation. As Chief AI Officer at Impact Networking, I lead a dual mission: accelerating AI adoption across the enterprise while developing frameworks for client transformation.

My career includes pioneering work in early e-commerce, content management systems, and streaming media, including founding a video streaming startup five years before YouTube. I've developed original frameworks for human-AI collaboration, most notably *Thought Architecture™*, a methodology grounded in organizational learning theory that guides organizations toward AI implementations that amplify human intelligence rather than merely automate tasks.

Technology should serve human flourishing, not replace it. My work holds that line, especially when the pressure to automate and optimize threatens to hollow out what makes work meaningful in the first place.

That's the real work.

TEACHING PHILOSOPHY

I believe AI education must move beyond tool tutorials toward developing judgment, the capacity to think critically about when, why, and how to deploy AI in organizational contexts. My approach is rooted in experiential learning: students engage with real business problems, develop frameworks for analysis, and confront the human dimensions of technological change.

Effective AI leadership requires understanding not just the technology but the fear, resistance, and cultural dynamics that accompany transformation. I teach from active practice, bringing current case studies from my work leading AI initiatives across diverse industries including manufacturing, professional services, healthcare, and logistics.

AREAS OF INSTRUCTIONAL EXPERTISE

Human-Centered AI Strategy

Frameworks for AI adoption that prioritize workforce augmentation over replacement; organizational change management for AI initiatives; building trust and transparency in AI-enabled workplaces

AI Transformation Leadership

Developing AI maturity assessments; use case discovery and prioritization; measuring success beyond efficiency metrics; navigating the gap between AI hype and operational reality

Thought Architecture: Human-AI Collaboration Methodology

Original framework (Intention → Context → Synthesize → Deliver) grounded in Simon's bounded rationality, Polanyi's tacit knowledge, and Nonaka's knowledge creation theory; practical application to business problems

Technology Transformation Across Eras

Comparative analysis of technology waves (dot-com, cloud, mobile, AI); patterns of adoption, resistance, and organizational adaptation; lessons from 25 years of leading change

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS & THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

"How Leaders Can Center Humanity in an AI-Driven World." Workflow Magazine, March 2025.

"Keeping Humanity at the Center of AI: Three Steps Leaders Can Take Today." ENX Magazine, March 2025.

"Beyond Training Theater: How to Build Learning That Works." ENX Magazine, October 2025.

"Diversification vs. Transformation: Reflections on AI Changing Your Business." ENX Magazine, September 2025.

"The Reality of AI Development" (Thought Architecture Framework). Impact Networking, May 2025.

"Building the Future: The Essential Components of a Great AI Team." Impact Networking, January 2025.

SELECTED SPEAKING & PUBLIC EDUCATION

AI Knowhow Podcast (Knownwell): Featured guest discussing how companies should start AI initiatives and move from vision to practical implementation

The Exigent Legal Tech MashUp Podcast: Panelist on "Beyond the Buzzwords: Actual Applications of AI, Blockchain and RPA in the Real World"

LinkedIn Live: Assessments & Insights Series: AI consulting solutions for digital transformation

Impact Optimize Conference: Breakout session on evolving roles of IT and business users in RPA projects

Digital Transformation Summit: Presentations on RPA, AI and process automation

APPLIED TEACHING EXPERIENCE

AI Transformation Lab Workshops

Designed and facilitated hands-on executive education workshops guiding business leaders through AI maturity assessment, use case discovery, and prototype development. Participants leave with working proof-of-concept applications and action plans.

Enterprise AI Education & Enablement

Led internal training programs across Impact Networking, developing curriculum for AI adoption, responsible use policies, and human-AI collaboration practices for diverse functional teams.

Client-Facing AI Education

Delivered AI maturity assessments and strategic workshops for mid-market enterprises across manufacturing, professional services, and healthcare sectors.

SELECTED PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Chief AI Officer

Impact Networking

2024 to Present

Executive leader of the Department of AI, responsible for internal AI enablement and external client transformation services. Built cross-disciplinary team focused on human-centered AI solutions. Architected Managed Digital Transformation (MDX) framework. Developed go-to-market strategy for AI consulting services.

Vice President, Managed Digital Transformation

Impact Networking

2022 to 2024

Directed Digital Innovation team prioritizing automation, user design, and AI enablement for internal and customer-facing solutions.

Director of Solutions Architecture

Impact Networking

2019 to 2022

Built and led team responsible for designing and deploying scalable technology solutions across diverse industries.

Senior Solutions Architect / Senior Information Architect

Impact Networking

2007 to 2019

Progressive technical leadership roles spanning content management, workflow automation, and enterprise system integration.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT & CREDENTIALS

Generative AI: Executive Strategies to Unlock Enterprise Value, Kellogg Executive Education, Northwestern University

AI Strategies for Business Transformation, Kellogg School of Management

Professional Agile Leadership I (PAL I), Scrum.org

Multiple Agile and Scrum certifications from accredited platforms

AFFILIATIONS & ADVISORY ROLES

Advisory Board Member (Incoming), Opera Biosciences (Biotech)

Technology Advisory Board Member, Tutt LLC (Sustainable Fashion & Consumer Advocacy)

Member, Punks & Pinstripes (Professional Development Community)